

Calculus Review II:

Monotonicity, Integration

Methods, Applications, and

More

N-20251210

§1.1 Strict monotonicity from the derivative

If f is differentiable on an interval I and

$$f'(x) > 0 \quad (x \in I),$$

then f is strictly increasing on I . If

$$f'(x) < 0 \quad (x \in I),$$

then f is strictly decreasing.

The proof uses the Lagrange mean value theorem. For $x_2 > x_1$,

$$f(x_2) - f(x_1) = f'(\xi)(x_2 - x_1)$$

for some $\xi \in (x_1, x_2)$. If $f'(\xi) > 0$, then the difference is positive.

§1.2 First derivative test for extrema

Suppose f is continuous near x_0 and differentiable in the punctured neighborhood. If the sign of f' changes from negative to positive at x_0 , then $f(x_0)$ is a local minimum. If the sign changes from positive to negative, then $f(x_0)$ is a local maximum.

The page records the compact criterion:

$$(x - x_0)f'(x) > 0 \implies f(x_0) \text{ is a local minimum,}$$

$$(x - x_0)f'(x) < 0 \implies f(x_0) \text{ is a local maximum.}$$

§1.3 Second derivative test

If

$$f'(x_0) = 0, \quad f''(x_0) \neq 0,$$

then

$$f''(x_0) > 0 \implies x_0 \text{ is a local minimum,}$$

$$f''(x_0) < 0 \implies x_0 \text{ is a local maximum.}$$

The handwritten note adds the mnemonic that $f'' > 0$ looks like a smile and $f'' < 0$ looks like a frown.

§1.4 Concavity and inflection points

A curve segment is concave up if it lies above its tangent lines, and concave down if it lies below its tangent lines. In the usual calculus language,

$$f''(x) > 0$$

indicates concave up, while

$$f''(x) < 0$$

indicates concave down.

An inflection point is a point where the concavity changes. A necessary condition, when f'' exists, is

$$f''(x_0) = 0.$$

But this is not sufficient. The note highlights that $f''(x_0) = 0$ or nonexistence of $f''(x_0)$ only gives candidates; one must check whether the sign of f'' changes across x_0 .

The scanned page distinguishes several types: smooth horizontal inflection, smooth non-horizontal inflection, and sharp or vertical tangent behavior. The visual test is concavity change, not merely whether the tangent exists.

§1.5 Asymptotes

The notes classify asymptotes.

A vertical asymptote occurs when

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = \pm\infty.$$

Then $x = x_0$ is a vertical asymptote.

A horizontal asymptote occurs when

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow +\infty} f(x) = c \quad \text{or} \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} f(x) = c.$$

Then $y = c$ is a horizontal asymptote.

For an oblique asymptote

$$y = ax + b,$$

we require

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} [f(x) - (ax + b)] = 0.$$

The page derives

$$a = \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{f(x)}{x},$$

and then

$$b = \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} (f(x) - ax).$$

These formulas are highlighted in the source.

§1.6 General procedure for sketching a curve

The pages give a curve-sketching checklist:

- (i) determine the domain;
- (ii) check symmetry and periodicity;
- (iii) compute $f'(x)$ and $f''(x)$;
- (iv) find critical points and possible inflection points;
- (v) determine intervals of monotonicity and concavity;
- (vi) find asymptotes;
- (vii) locate intercepts or special points if useful;
- (viii) draw the graph according to this information.

This is not a mechanical ritual. The derivative table tells how the curve moves; the second derivative table tells how it bends; asymptotes determine the large-scale shape.

§1.7 Basic antiderivative table

The integration section records standard formulas:

$$\int 0 \, dx = C, \quad \int x^\mu \, dx = \frac{x^{\mu+1}}{\mu+1} + C \quad (\mu \neq -1),$$

$$\int \frac{1}{x} \, dx = \ln |x| + C, \quad \int a^x \, dx = \frac{a^x}{\ln a} + C.$$

Trigonometric formulas include

$$\int \sin x \, dx = -\cos x + C, \quad \int \cos x \, dx = \sin x + C,$$

$$\int \sec^2 x \, dx = \tan x + C, \quad \int \csc^2 x \, dx = -\cot x + C,$$

$$\int \frac{dx}{\sqrt{1-x^2}} = \arcsin x + C, \quad \int \frac{dx}{1+x^2} = \arctan x + C.$$

The page also lists logarithmic forms such as

$$\int \frac{dx}{\sqrt{x^2+a^2}} = \ln |x + \sqrt{x^2+a^2}| + C.$$

§1.8 Substitution

For a composite function, the substitution rule is

$$\int f(arphi(v))arphi'(v) \, dv = \int f(u) \, du, \quad u = arphi(v).$$

Equivalently,

$$\int f(u) \, du = \int f(arphi(v))arphi'(v) \, dv.$$

The scanned page calls the two directions the first and second substitution methods. The first recognizes a derivative already present; the second introduces a new variable to simplify the integral.

§1.9 Integration by parts

From

$$d(uv) = u dv + v du,$$

one obtains

$$\int u dv = uv - \int v du.$$

The page presents integration by parts as the other major method after substitution. Its use depends on choosing u so that differentiating it simplifies the expression and choosing dv so that it can be integrated.

§1.10 Rational functions and partial fractions

A rational function is

$$\frac{P(x)}{Q(x)},$$

where P, Q are polynomials and $Q \neq 0$. If $\deg P \geq \deg Q$, first divide polynomials to write it as a polynomial plus a proper rational function.

The pages list the elementary partial fraction forms. A real linear factor $(x - a)^k$ contributes

$$\frac{A_1}{x - a} + \frac{A_2}{(x - a)^2} + \cdots + \frac{A_k}{(x - a)^k}.$$

An irreducible quadratic factor $(x^2 + px + q)^k$ with $p^2 - 4q < 0$ contributes

$$\frac{M_1x + N_1}{x^2 + px + q} + \cdots + \frac{M_kx + N_k}{(x^2 + px + q)^k}.$$

Thus integration of rational functions reduces to two basic integral types:

$$\int \frac{dx}{(x - a)^k}, \quad \int \frac{Mx + N}{(x^2 + px + q)^k} dx.$$

§1.11 Quadratic denominator reduction

For the second type, split the numerator as a derivative part plus a remainder:

$$Mx + N = \frac{M}{2}(2x + p) + \left(N - \frac{M}{2}p\right).$$

Then

$$\int \frac{Mx + N}{(x^2 + px + q)^k} dx = \frac{M}{2} I_k^1 + \left(N - \frac{M}{2}p\right) I_k^2,$$

where

$$I_k^1 = \int \frac{d(x^2 + px + q)}{(x^2 + px + q)^k},$$

and

$$I_k^2 = \int \frac{dx}{(x^2 + px + q)^k}.$$

Complete the square by setting

$$t = x + \frac{p}{2}, \quad a^2 = q - \frac{p^2}{4} > 0.$$

Then

$$x^2 + px + q = t^2 + a^2.$$

For $k = 1$,

$$I_1^2 = \frac{1}{a} \arctan \frac{t}{a} + C.$$

For higher k , the recurrence shown on the page is

$$I_{k+1}^2 = \frac{1}{2ka^2} \left(\frac{t}{(t^2 + a^2)^k} + (2k - 1)I_k^2 \right).$$

§1.12 Trigonometric rational functions

The notes next handle rational functions of $\sin x$ and $\cos x$. Use the tangent half-angle substitution

$$t = an \frac{x}{2}, \quad -\pi < x < \pi.$$

Then

$$\sin x = \frac{2t}{1+t^2}, \quad \cos x = \frac{1-t^2}{1+t^2}, \quad an x = \frac{2t}{1-t^2},$$

and

$$dx = \frac{2 dt}{1+t^2}.$$

Thus

$$\int R(\sin x, \cos x) dx = \int R\left(\frac{2t}{1+t^2}, \frac{1-t^2}{1+t^2}\right) \frac{2 dt}{1+t^2},$$

which becomes a rational integral in t .

§1.13 Definite integrals and Riemann sums

The page defines the definite integral. Divide $[a, b]$ by

$$a = x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n = b,$$

let

$$\Delta x_i = x_i - x_{i-1},$$

and choose sample points $\xi_i \in [x_{i-1}, x_i]$. The Riemann sum is

$$\sum_{i=1}^n f(\xi_i) \Delta x_i.$$

If the limit exists as the mesh

$$\lambda = \max_i \Delta x_i$$

tends to zero, then

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx$$

is the definite integral.

The pages list sufficient conditions for integrability: continuous functions, monotone bounded functions, and bounded functions with finitely many discontinuities are integrable on closed intervals.

§1.14 Basic properties of definite integrals

The standard properties are:

$$\int_a^b [\alpha f(x) + \beta g(x)] dx = \alpha \int_a^b f(x) dx + \beta \int_a^b g(x) dx,$$

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx = - \int_b^a f(x) dx, \quad \int_a^a f(x) dx = 0,$$

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx = \int_a^c f(x) dx + \int_c^b f(x) dx.$$

If $f(x) \geq 0$ on $[a, b]$, then

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx \geq 0.$$

If $f \leq g$, then

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx \leq \int_a^b g(x) dx.$$

§1.15 Integral mean value theorem

Theorem 1.15.1 (Integral mean value theorem)

If f is continuous on $[a, b]$, then there exists $c \in [a, b]$ such that

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx = f(c)(b - a).$$

If f is continuous on $[a, b]$, then there exists $\xi \in [a, b]$ such that

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx = f(\xi)(b - a).$$

If g does not change sign, the weighted form is

$$\int_a^b f(x)g(x) dx = f(\xi) \int_a^b g(x) dx.$$

The note uses this to interpret integrals as average values.

§1.16 Applications: area, volume, and arc length

Area between curves is computed by

$$A = \int_a^b [f(x) - g(x)] dx$$

when $f \geq g$. If horizontal slicing is better,

$$A = \int_c^d [x_{right}(y) - x_{left}(y)] dy.$$

The volume of a solid of revolution around the x -axis is

$$V = \pi \int_a^b [f(x)]^2 dx.$$

The shell method has the form

$$V = 2\pi \int_a^b x f(x) dx$$

when rotating a region around the y -axis.

Arc length of $y = f(x)$ is

$$L = \int_a^b \sqrt{1 + [f'(x)]^2} dx.$$

For a parametric curve $x = x(t), y = y(t)$,

$$L = \int_\alpha^\beta \sqrt{(x'(t))^2 + (y'(t))^2} dt.$$

§1.17 Improper integrals

The last pages include reminders about improper integrals. If the interval is unbounded,

$$\int_a^{+\infty} f(x) dx = \lim_{R \rightarrow +\infty} \int_a^R f(x) dx.$$

If the integrand has a singularity at b , then

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx = \lim_{t \rightarrow b^-} \int_a^t f(x) dx.$$

Convergence depends on the existence of these limits.

A standard comparison is the p -integral:

$$\int_1^\infty \frac{dx}{x^p}$$

converges iff $p > 1$, while

$$\int_0^1 \frac{dx}{x^p}$$

converges iff $p < 1$.

§1.18 Broader perspective

This note connects derivative information with the global shape of a curve, then connects antiderivatives with accumulation. Derivatives decide monotonicity, extrema, concavity, inflection points, and asymptotes. Integration methods reduce complicated antiderivatives to known forms. Definite integrals turn limits of sums into area, volume, length, and average value. The same calculus ideas are being used both for qualitative geometry and quantitative computation.

§1.19 Monotonicity and derivative sign

If $f' \geq 0$ on an interval, the mean value theorem gives

$$f(y) - f(x) = f'(c)(y - x) \geq 0 \quad (x < y).$$

So monotonicity is not a separate rule; it is a global consequence of local derivative sign.

Strict monotonicity needs care: $f' > 0$ everywhere is sufficient, but not necessary. Functions can be strictly increasing even when the derivative vanishes at isolated or many points.

§1.20 Convexity and supporting lines

Convexity can be read geometrically: the graph lies below chords and above supporting tangent lines. If f is differentiable and convex, then

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + f'(x)(y - x).$$

This inequality is the foundation of many optimization methods.

§1.21 Integration methods as inverse rules

Substitution reverses the chain rule, integration by parts reverses the product rule, and partial fractions use algebraic decomposition before integration. These methods are not unrelated tricks; each integration technique recognizes which differentiation rule produced the integrand.

§1.22 Error terms and numerical integration

Midpoint and trapezoidal error formulas depend on second derivatives. They express how curvature controls the difference between an integral and a simple area approximation. In numerical analysis, this becomes a systematic study of quadrature rules and convergence rates.

§1.23 Local derivative data and global shape

Curve sketching, monotonicity, extrema, concavity, asymptotes, integration methods, and numerical errors all use derivatives to convert local information into global shape or accumulated quantity.